

Requirements Elicitation

Navigating the Path to Project Success

Department of ICT, Faculty of Technology

OUTLINE



What Is Elicitation?



Elicitation Techniques



Selecting the Right Elicitation Technique

RECOMMENDED TEXTBOOKS

“Business Analysis (4th Edition)” by “ Debra Paul, James Cadle”
Publisher: BCS, The Chartered Institute for IT 2020

“Business Analyst” by “Adrian Reed “ Publisher: BCS, The Chartered
Institute for IT 2018

Requirements Elicitation

Definition

- Elicitation refers to the process of gathering information from stakeholders to identify and define project requirements.
- Actively engaging the stakeholder in defining requirements for the business, the stakeholder, solution or transition

Purpose of Requirements Elicitation

- To understand stakeholder needs, preferences, and expectations.
- To ensure that project objectives are clearly understood and aligned with stakeholder interests.

Elicitation Process

Prepare for Elicitation

Schedule Resources, Supporting Materials

Conduct Elicitation Activity

Elicitation Results

Document Elicitation Results

Requirements Defined and Prioritized

Stakeholder Concerns, Assumptions and Constraints

Confirm Elicitation Results

Requirements Confirmed

Stakeholder Concerns Confirmed

Elicitation Techniques

- Brainstorming
- Existing Document Analysis
- Focus Groups
- Interface Analysis
- Interviews
- Observation
- Prototyping
- Requirements Workshops
- Survey/Questionnaire

Brainstorming

- Produce numerous new ideas
- Record an a list visible to everyone
- Establish criteria for rating the ideas
- A skilled moderator manages the group discussion
- Rate the ideas and distribute the final list

Survey/Questionnaire

- Survey questions come in two types
 - Closed questions
 - Open-ended questions
- Preparing the survey
 - Define the purpose of the survey
 - Choose the audience and sample size
 - Write the survey questions
 - Test the survey questions

Overview of Elicitation Techniques

- **Interviews** - Conducting one-on-one or group discussions with stakeholders.
- **Surveys** - Collecting feedback from stakeholders through structured surveys.

Overview of Elicitation Techniques

- **Observations** - Observing stakeholders in their work environment to understand their processes and challenges.
- **Prototyping** - Building prototypes or mock-ups to visualize requirements and gather feedback.

Selecting the Right Elicitation Technique

Stakeholder Availability

- Consider the availability and accessibility of stakeholders for different techniques.

Complexity of Requirements

- Choose techniques that are suitable for capturing both simple and complex requirements.

Selecting the Right Elicitation Technique

Stakeholder Preferences

- Take into account stakeholders' preferences and comfort levels with different elicitation methods.

Project Constraints

- Consider time, budget, and resource constraints when selecting elicitation techniques.

Tacit knowledge & Explicit knowledge

Tacit knowledge

Tacit knowledge is personal, experience-based knowledge that's difficult to articulate or formalize. It's often gained through trial and error, intuition, and accumulated experience in a specific context.

Tacit knowledge & Explicit knowledge

Explicit knowledge

Explicit knowledge, on the other hand, is easily communicated and documented. It's information that can be readily written down, shared, and taught. Often, it comes from sources like textbooks, manuals, lectures, or presentations.

Knowledge as an Iceberg Model

Explicit Knowledge:

- ✓ Manuals
- ✓ Documents
- ✓ Procedures
- ✓ How-To-Guides
- ✓ Videos
- ✓ Databases
- ✓ How-To-Guides
- ✓ Notes
- ✓ Records

Tacit Knowledge:

- ✓ Individual Skill
- ✓ Expertise
- ✓ Education
- ✓ Experience
- ✓ Ideas
- ✓ Insights
- ✓ Intuition
- ✓ Observations
- ✓ Cultural Beliefs
- ✓ Values
- ✓ Attitudes
- ✓ Mental Models



Tacit knowledge & Explicit knowledge

Imagine you're learning to ride a bike.

Explicit knowledge The rules of the road, proper hand signaling, safety equipment, basic bike mechanics (e.g., how to change a flat tire) – all this can be found in manuals, videos, or even someone explaining it to you.

Tacit knowledge The subtle feel of the balance, how to adjust your weight for different maneuvers, the intuitive "gut feeling" of upcoming obstacles – these come from practice and are harder to put into words.

Using a example gather requirements from stakeholders for a project . What elicitation techniques you are going to use, and how do they contribute to understanding stakeholder needs and expectations?

THANK YOU !